

Day 4 — Stair-Step Method (Nārāyaṇa)

Module: Magic Squares — Bhadragaṇita · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: apply nārāyaṇa’s algorithm to build a 5×5 square.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *bhadra-gaṇita* (IAST: bhadra-gaṇita; lit. “auspicious arithmetic” — the Indian term for magic squares”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **State the observable phenomenon first.** Whatever the day’s idea is — a number trick, a celestial pattern, a herb’s identifying feature — start with the thing students can see, hear, or do.
2. **Introduce the Sanskrit term.** Once, in the triple format, then italicised only.
3. **Build the conceptual map.** Connect today’s idea to prior modules (especially Module 2 if applicable) and prior days.
4. **Work an example** with the whole class on the board.
5. **Independent or paired practice** for ~5 minutes.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Class 3×3 Magic-Square Tournament* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Stair-Step Method (Nārāyaṇa).

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today's task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).